A-A-53127
6 August 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLUGS, EAR
(Hearing Protection, Cylindrical, With Cord)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a single type of ear plug used for hearing protection.

Salient characteristics:

Materials. The ear plug shall be fabricated of virgin polyvinyl chloride plastic foam which is non-dermatitic, non-toxic, and non-allergenic. The ear plug shall be yellow within the limits of Federal Standard 595A, Colors No. 33637 and 33793. The density of the ear plug shall be 0.080 to 0.108 gm/cc and have a fine cell structure with no cell dimension exceeding 1.27 mm when examined under a low power microscope with an accurately calibrated ocular micrometer. The ear plug shall recover 90% of its original diameter in 5 to 60 seconds after being compressed for one minute and clocked for the time required to be held by a glass tube with an ID substantially the same as the original diameter of the ear plug. One half of the ear plugs in this recovery test shall be conditioned at 50% ± 5% relative humidity and the other half at 100% - 5%, + 0% for 24 hours.

The connecting cord shall be plasticized polyvinyl chloride.

Design and construction. The ear plug shall have no jagged edges and be smooth on all surfaces, be cylindrical in shape and measure 0.53 to 0.56 inch in diameter and 0.65 to 0.80 inch in length. The connecting cord shall be 20 to 27.5 inches between the plugs and have a diameter of about 0.065 inch.

Sound attenuation. Sound attenuation shall be determined by ANSI S12.6, Measurement of the Real-Ear Attenuation of Hearing Protectors at Thresnold and comply with the following minimum values.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Frequency (Hz)	Mean Attenuation (dB)
125	26
250	29
500	30
1000	29
2000	33
3150	37
4000	37
6300	38
8000	37

Resistance to heat and humidity. The ear plug shall not become discolored when exposed at 70°C ± 2°C and 97% ± 3% relative humidity for 336 hours ± 2 hours.

Flammability. The ear plug shall not burn more than 10 seconds after removal of the flame when tested to ASTM D568 except that the plug shall be suspended by a thin wire and the flame applied for 5 seconds.

Patch tests. Of 100 human volunteers, no more than one shall show a positive reaction to 25 mm discs of the foam material applied as a patch. There shall be nine 24-hour exposures in 3 weeks. After a two-week rest, there shall be another 24-hour exposure. Observations are made after 24 hours from the time of patch removal. For the final exposure, an observation is also made after 72 hours. Distinct erythema constitutes a positive reaction.

Security of attachment. The ear plugs shall support a 1.5 lb. load for three minutes without becoming loose or separating from the cord. The load shall be applied simultaneously to both ear plugs of the pair.

Instructions. Complete instructions shall be furnished with each pair of ear plugs.

Workmanship. The ear plugs shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred individually packaged pairs of ear plugs with instructions for use, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as shown in Table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one pair of ear plugs.

Table I. Sampling criteria for examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL % defective
Major	S-3	1.0
Minor	S-3	1.5

For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as shown in Table II. The unit for test purposes shall be one pair of ear plugs.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling Criteria for examination.

Characteristic	Inspection	AQL % Defective
Density	S-2	1.0
Cell size	S-2	1.5
Recovery from compression	S-3	1.0
Sound attenuation	S-3	1.0
Heat and humidity	S-2	1.0
Flammability	S-1	1.0
Patch test	See test above	
Security of attachment	S-1	1.0

Examination. The ear plug shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and II. Examination however shall not be confined to the defects listed in Table III.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Not free of foreign material.
102	Irregular surface, edges not smooth.
103	Top and bottom surfaces not flat and parallel.
104	Sides not straight and parallel.
105	Dimensions not as specified.
Minor	
201	Variations of color or shade within same package.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-157-1278	PLUGS, EAR, Hearing Protection, Cylindrical, With Cord, With Case, Universal Size, 200s, (100 PR)

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior packaging quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4097

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN DPSC-PST
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101-8-19

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53127	PLUGS, EAR (Hearing Protection, Cylindrical, With Cord).

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.